



Even Keel

The December 2026 CEA link — the proposal in ten minutes

For managers · 26 weeks · code EK-26-H1 · the full proposal sheet has the detail

The short version

Four numbers

9 of 9

**December rules
met**

today's link: 4

35h

**contract
rostered exactly,
on average**

Monday to Saturday

0

**avoidable
fatigue warnings**

in the fixed rota ·
today 4

26

**people on the
link**

today: 20

Every December rule met — and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

The staffing you asked for

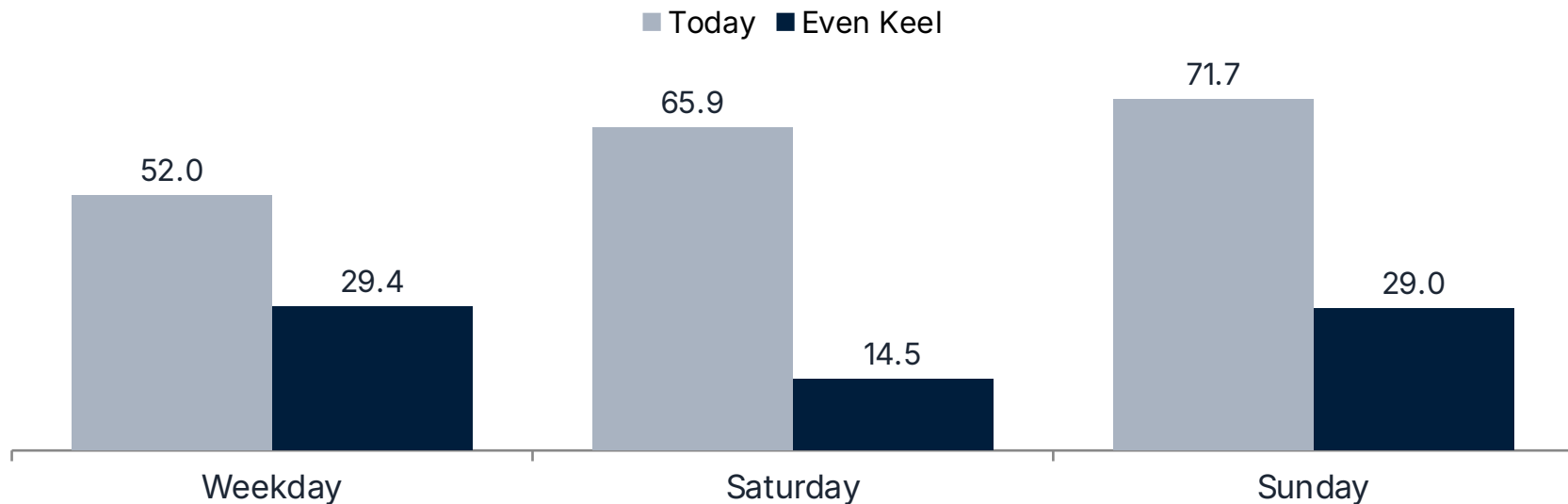
Weekday · Saturday · Sunday

	Today	Even Keel
On duty during the day	11-12 · 10 · 8	15 · 14 · 10
At the open (06:20, Sunday 07:15)	4 · 4 · 3	5 · 5 · 4
Still on after 22:00	4 · 2 · 3	7 · 5 · 5
Through to the close	2 · 2 · 3	3 · 4 · 3
Fewest rostered on the floor	2 · 2 · 2	3 · 3 · 3

Every level met on every day — and the ticket office staffed in pairs, including Sundays.

People where the trains are

How far the floor staffing is from the shape of the December timetable — lower is better



Much closer to the December pattern on weekdays, Saturday and Sunday.

People and hours

What it takes to run

	Today	Even Keel
People on the link	20	26
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Cover weeks (for leave and sickness)	4 — 1 week in 5	5 — 1 week in 5
People needed each Sunday (overtime)	8	10

Six more people, 35 hours a week on average — Sundays still rely on overtime.

Fatigue checks

Against the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice list and the rail industry's own checks

	Today	Even Keel
Avoidable fatigue warnings, fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	0
Most days in a row (limit 13)	7 (up to 9)	5 (up to 6)
Shortest rest between shifts (limit 12h)	12h 30m	14h 35m
Longest shift	9h 10m	9h 00m

Rest and run limits met with room to spare; no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

Why Even Keel?

One shift time in 18 of 21 weeks, and no week over 41h 30m

- ✓ Meets all 9 December rules, and all 3 flexible ones
- ✓ Seven full weekends off in 26, never more than five weeks apart
- ✓ Never more than 5 days in a row in the fixed duties — today 7
- ✓ 8 of its 15 shift times are worked today
- ✓ No shift over 9 hours, and every closing shift is shorter
- ✓ No avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota

The trade-off: five more late finishes a year each (44, today 39), and seven new shift times.

What colleagues will notice

The good and the not so good — the colleague presentation shows both

Likely to welcome

- 7 weekends off, at most 5 weeks apart
- One shift time in 18 of 21 weeks (today 7 of 16)
- At most 5 days in a row (today 7)
- No week over 41h 30m Monday to Saturday
- Shortest rest 14h 35m (today 12h 30m)

Likely to worry about

- Late finishes: 44 a year (today 39)
- 7 new shift times to learn, 2 on a Saturday
- Average shift about 2 minutes longer
- Best 14-day leave stretch 28 days, not 30
- Four weeks off takes 15 days' leave at best, not 14

Expect late finishes to be the first question — the colleague deck answers it openly.

Where it stands

Three things confirmed verbally (29 Sep and 1 Oct 2026), two decisions left



December rules — confirmed

The nine December rules. Everything here is built on them.



26 people on the link — confirmed

Six more than today, with five cover weeks.



Sunday cover — confirmed

Ten on a Sunday — Sunday work stays overtime.



To decide: which link we use

Colleagues' views come first.



Then: who starts on which line

Who begins on which week of the link.



The detail

- Every week of the link, day by day
- Staff on duty hour by hour, against the trains
- Every December rule and fatigue check, worked through

All in the eight-page proposal sheet · Even Keel · EK-26-H1